

06 SLEEP IS STRENGTH

Sleep is one of the most powerful tools a boxer has.

SEASON

1

WEEK

6

FOCUS

HEALTHY HABITS

KEY PHRASE

“Be unrealistic.”

SUMMARY

This practice focuses on sleep as a driver of performance and wellbeing. A True or False activity debunks common sleep myths, then fighters build a realistic three-step sleep routine for the week. Training is a Simon Says round through every punch and the slip, then combination prep on the mitts. The burnout repeats the Week 2 assessment.

MATERIALS

- Fighter’s Mindset journal
- Mitts & gloves
- Speaker · the Week 2 song
- Writing utensils

OBJECTIVES

By the end of this practice, fighters will:

1. List the benefits of sleep
2. Identify behaviors that create a sleep routine

COACH MESSAGE

15 MIN

SAY

Who feels well-rested, like you slept enough last night? [Ask for a show of hands.]

Much like how you eat affects how you train, how you sleep does too. Sleep is one of the most powerful tools a boxer can use. It improves your reaction time and focus, lets your muscles recover and build, and helps your memory. Most importantly, it gives you the energy to train hard and stay focused. Getting enough sleep is one way we prepare to do our best at training.

ACTIVITY · TRUE OR FALSE Directions

1. Designate one side of the room **true** and the other **false**.
2. Read the statement.
3. Ask fighters to share why they chose that side.
4. Read the response below the statement.
5. Fighters return to the middle for the next statement.

FALSE Watching TV or going on my phone is a good way to relax before bed.

It seems like scrolling or watching a show helps you chill out, but screens make it harder for your brain to fall asleep. Blue light from phones, tablets, and TVs interferes with your brain's sleep signals, it can delay sleep, reduce total sleep time, and make sleep feel lighter. A better way to relax: reading, stretching, or calming music.

TRUE Teenagers need more sleep than adults.

Teenage brains and bodies are developing quickly, so you need more sleep than an adult does.

TRUE If I miss sleep during the week, I can't catch up by sleeping more on the weekends.

It's common to think you'll just sleep in Saturday to make up for the week, but your body can't fully recover lost sleep. Sleeping too little all week and catching up on weekends throws off your rhythm and leaves you groggy. Going to bed and waking up around the same time every day works better, that rhythm makes your sleep stronger.

FALSE Sleeping more is always better than getting the right amount of sleep.

The goal isn't more sleep, it's the right amount, for most of you, around 8 to 10 hours every night. More than that can make you feel more tired. What matters most is quality sleep, every night. That's when your body repairs itself, your brain processes what you learned, and your energy is restored.

FALSE If I consistently sleep less, my brain and body will adjust and learn to function normally.

People say "I'm just used to five hours," but research shows the brain doesn't adapt, it gets slower. Memory, reaction time, and focus all go down. For boxers that means slower punches, weaker reactions, and more risk of injury. You can't train your body to function on too little sleep; you only train it to underperform.

FALSE An energy drink in the afternoon has worn off by the time I go to bed.

Caffeine stays in your body far longer than the buzz lasts, half of it can still be in your system six hours later. A drink at 4pm is still working at 10pm. If you need something in the afternoon, water does more for your training than caffeine does.

TRUE Going to bed and waking up at the same time matters as much as how long you sleep.

Your body runs on a rhythm. When you keep the same bedtime and wake time, your brain starts preparing for sleep before you lie down, so you fall asleep faster and sleep deeper. A steady schedule beats a long, random one.

FALSE I can fall asleep faster if I lie in bed on my phone until I feel tired.

Lying in bed awake on a screen teaches your brain that bed is a place to be alert. Get off the screen first, then get into bed. If you can't sleep after about 20 minutes, get up, do something calm, and come back.

SAY **JRNL** Also in the fighter journals

Creating a routine for sleep, much like the preparation routine you made, helps you fall asleep quicker and sleep more deeply. Brushing your teeth, putting down your phone, and reading a book are three steps that help you wind down at night.

What helps you transition from being awake to relaxing?

Write a realistic three- to five-step sleep routine you can commit to this week. Your habits outside of training are just as important as the training itself.

EXAMPLE IDEAS

Shower

Phone away

Sleepy music

Meditation or breathing exercises

Read

White noise or a sound machine

Prepare clothes for the next day

JOURNAL Sleep routine

JRNL JOURNAL · WEEK 6

JOURNAL P. 10-11

MIDDLE SCHOOL

True or false activity, then create a sleep routine the same way you built your preparation routine. Write a realistic three to five step routine.

HIGH SCHOOL

Burnout is not just being tired, it is running on empty for so long that rest stops helping. Where in your life do you feel it: school, sports, family, your phone? What is one boundary that would actually protect your energy?

- Fighters write their three to five steps in their journals.
- Ask two or three fighters to share one step with the group.

INTENTIONS

5 MIN

Review the team SMART goal before fighters share.

SAY **JRNL** Also in the fighter journals

Today's guiding question: how can you take steps toward that goal today during practice?

□ TRAINING

30 MIN

REVIEW Every punch and the slip

- Fighters line up shoulder to shoulder in stance.
- Call each punch by number, 1 through 6, and hold long enough to correct form before the next call.
- Call **slip** to both sides, checking that the weight loads onto the back foot.
- Fix what needs fixing here. Simon Says is the test, this is the tune-up.

SIMON SAYS All punches and the slip

- Fighters line up shoulder to shoulder in stance.
- Call punches 1 through 6 and **slip**, fighters throw only on “Simon says.”
- Anyone who moves on a bare call does two shadow 1 · 2s and rejoins.
- Start predictable, then mix the order and pick up the pace.
- Use it to check form on every punch before combination work.

COMBO PREP Called combinations

FIGHTER PICKS ONE

1 · 2 · slip · 2 · 3 · 2 1 · 2 · slip · 6 · 5

She works the same combination all the way through, so the reps add up.

- Shadow the chosen combination first, until it runs clean without a partner.
- **Round 1:** the combination on the mitts, clean form.
- **Round 2:** the same combination with speed.
- **Round 3:** the same combination with power.
- Rounds run 30 to 90 seconds. Mitt holders give one piece of feedback per round, then switch roles.

□ BURNOUT · ASSESSMENT

7 MIN

ASSESSMENT

Repeat of the Week 2 assessment, same song and same format, so fighters can compare directly against their own number.

- Partners pair up with mitts and gloves. Play the same song used in Week 2 and start together.
- Each fighter throws 100 clean punches, 50 1 · 2 combinations, before the song ends, then partners switch.
- Fighters count their own punches out loud; the partner holding mitts confirms the count.
- Speed over power here. Staying on the beat matters more than how hard the punch lands.
- Record every fighter's count, whether or not she reached 100 before the song ended.
- Log every fighter on page 42, alongside her Week 2 number on page 23.

□ SHOUT-OUTS

3 MIN

- Ask the group: what did you see our team do that helped us get to our goal?
- Fighters share shout-outs, each ending with **snap clap**.

COACH NOTES AFTER PRACTICE

PUNCH COUNT ASSESSMENT LOG

Week 6 midpoint. Same song and same format as Week 2, so each fighter compares against her own number. Tick **Complete** if she reached 100 clean punches before the song ended. If she did not, write how many punches she threw.

DATE	SONG USED		LENGTH
FIGHTER PRESENT	COMPLETE	NOT COMPLETE	# OF PUNCHES THROWN
01	☐	☐	
02	☐	☐	
03	☐	☐	
04	☐	☐	
05	☐	☐	
06	☐	☐	
07	☐	☐	
08	☐	☐	
09	☐	☐	
10	☐	☐	
11	☐	☐	
12	☐	☐	
13	☐	☐	
14	☐	☐	
15	☐	☐	
16	☐	☐	
17	☐	☐	
18	☐	☐	
19	☐	☐	
20	☐	☐	